

Disease & Poison

Diseases may be physical or chimerical in origin, and while modern medical science may hold the cures to many scourges that once decimated populations, Banal individuals or structures may make it difficult for changelings to avail themselves of such aid. Thankfully, most freeholds have at least one person with some medical training, with the added bonus of being familiar with maladies that originate in the Dreaming, so most changelings who contract a disease are in good hands.

When a changeling is exposed to a disease, the changeling's player must roll Stamina at a difficulty set by the Storyteller, representing the virulence of the disease in question and the circumstances in which the changeling was exposed. For example, against an airborne illness, a changeling who properly covers her mouth and nose would be less likely to contract the disease. If this roll fails, the changeling contracts the illness. The common cold does little more than impose slight penalties to actions unless the character's immune system is compromised in some way, but more serious illnesses inflict levels of bashing damage that must be healed normally, representing the time necessary to completely clear the contagion from her system. Dangerous illnesses inflict lethal damage — this represents advanced symptoms such as fluid in the lungs or organ failure.

Like diseases, poisons may be chimerical or physical in nature. Unlike diseases, they are not infectious, but must be actively or accidentally introduced into the changeling's system to affect her. Some poisons affect the character even if she only touches the substance, while others require ingestion or injection. The old standby of the envenomed blade is a threat far more common on the chimerical side of reality, but not foreign to the Autumn world. The players of changelings exposed to poisons must make Stamina rolls to resist their effects.

Diseases and toxins are both classified with Toxin ratings, which determines how difficult they are to resist. Damage from drugs is only dealt once, save in the case of the most potent

toxins, and is dealt all at once. Diseases inflict damage in single-die increments over longer periods of time, ranging from days to weeks, and even months in the case of longer-term illnesses such as cancer.

A changeling may remove the effects of a chimerical poison or sickness by invoking the Autumn (p. 271) to deny their existence. Unlike other uses of Autumn to ignore chimerical effects, this lasts for one scene, and the changeling may otherwise interact with chimerical reality as usual.

Falling and Impact

It's not the fall that's lethal — it's the sudden stop at the end. For every 10 vertical feet a changeling falls, she takes one die of bashing damage, up to a maximum of 10. After 100 feet, the damage becomes lethal, but ceases to compound further, as the changeling has reached terminal velocity. If the changeling lands on a hazardous surface, such as a pile of jagged rocks, the damage upgrades by one degree — bashing becomes lethal, and lethal becomes aggravated. Falling damage cannot be soaked.

Falls are just as dangerous in the Dreaming, but unlike in the physical world, falling changelings can do something about their predicament. If the changeling is able to catch hold of objects on the way down, or if she manages to land in something that could reasonably be expected to cushion her fall, she halves whatever damage she would have taken and reduces it to bashing if it would have been lethal. In any case, falling damage in the Dreaming can be soaked.

Fall damage can also represent impacts, such as ramming into stationary objects or being struck by a vehicle. Generally speaking, for every 10 feet per turn traveled prior to impact, an individual should take one die of bashing damage. Two objects (or people) who crash into each other at high velocity combine their damage into a single pool, which is then applied to both. Changelings can soak chimerical impacts, but not physical ones, though armor always applies its soak to Impact damage.

Poison & Disease Toxicity

Toxin Rating	Difficulty	Disease	Poison or Drug
One	6	Common Cold(B)	Alcohol(B), THC(B)
Two	7	Chicken Pox(B), Food Poisoning(B), MRSA(L)	Methamphetamine(B), Methanol (L)
Three	7	Influenza(B),EarlyCancer(L),Pneumonia(L)	Tainted Water(B), Tear Gas (cloud*; B), Belladonna(L)
Four	8	HIV(L), Leprosy(L), Advanced Cancer(L)	Salmonella(B), Ammonia(L)
Five	8	Severe Flu(B/L), Cholera(B), Terminal Cancer (L)	Bleach(L), Industrial Waste (L)
Six	9	Bubonic Plague(L), Anthrax(L)	Strong Acids(L)
Seven	9/T3*	Ebola(L)	Sarin(L), Cyanide(L)

* Clouds of noxious gases or airborne diseases cannot be dodged. Protective gear must be worn or protective Arts used to prevent their effects.